

How the Holy Spirit Helps Us

Romans 8:23 through 30 shows the Holy Spirit's ability to overcome every obstacle, including the flesh, and work God's plan. He does this not only on the scale of the seven-thousand-year plan of God, but also in the span of your own life.

Paul is showing us that the Holy Spirit has been sent to help us fulfill the perfect plan, purpose, and call of God. Romans 8:26 says:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought...

The infirmities here are not only physical weaknesses. They are anything that detours you from fulfilling the perfect will of God for your life. Any mountain, boulder, or obstruction that stands in the way of you finding and fulfilling God's plan is an infirmity in this sense.

The Spirit steps in and makes intercession with groanings which cannot be uttered. He that searches the heart knows the mind of the Spirit, and because the Spirit knows the plan of God, He can make intercession for you according to the will of God. Then, because He is making intercession according to the will of God, all things begin to work together for good to those who love God and are called according to His purpose.

The infirmities Paul is talking about work on three levels.

The first level is filthiness of flesh. This is where many holiness groups have stopped: drinking, smoking, chewing, sexual sin, and outward habits.

The second level is filthiness of soul. This includes hatred, strife, unforgiveness, and the emotional realms of the soul.

The third level is filthiness of spirit. This has to do with wrong believing and incorrect doctrine. Second Corinthians speaks of cleansing ourselves from all filthiness of flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness. We are not saying your born-again spirit is sinning in the old sense. We are saying your spirit can receive and believe incorrect doctrine, and wrong believing can become one of the greatest obstructions to the call of God in your life.

The Holy Spirit has offered Himself for mortification in all three realms: flesh, soul, and spirit. He baptized your spirit, and He came to teach your spirit. As God teaches your spirit through the Holy Spirit, He works to communicate that truth over into your soul.

If your spirit already knew everything just because it received a new nature, then why would teaching continue after a person enters heaven? The Holy Spirit came because your spirit must be taught.

The Holy Spirit reveals things that can only be understood by the spirit. The carnal mind is enmity against God. Without the new nature, the mind could not even understand the things of the Spirit.

In 1 Corinthians 2, when Paul says this wisdom is spoken "not in the words which man's wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth," he is not talking only about the language of praying in tongues. He is saying that after man was born again, the Holy Spirit had to come from heaven and teach the whole mystery of salvation: the cross, the baptism in the Holy Ghost, speaking with tongues, and redemption.

All of this had been hidden in a mystery. It had to be taught by the Holy Spirit to holy men of God, beginning with Jesus and then the apostles. Its origin was not in this world. It was a whole new language and understanding born around the cross, something the carnal mind could not grasp.

The Holy Spirit's job is to cause us to understand those things. The first thing He did was give us a language to pray those mysteries. When you spend nights in prayer, it becomes His task afterward to communicate those mysteries to your mind. That is why I am confident in what I believe: I understand it from the Holy Spirit.

Romans 12 builds on the mortification process taught in Romans 8:

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice...

Based on what Romans 8 teaches, Paul is saying, "Go on and offer your body by the power of the Holy Spirit. Let Him mortify in the areas of spirit, soul, and body so you can prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God."

We all have grace and callings as individual members of the body. But if false doctrine captures you, your calling can come to rest at a merely good or acceptable level. If you do not believe miracles are for today, or you do not believe in much prayer, that false doctrine can neutralize you doctrinally.

You must be purged in the emotional realms of the soul until you adopt the Word as the final say-so and can stay in prayer because the Word has first priority, not because your emotions permit it.

Then the Holy Spirit deals with your doctrine. If your doctrine is not straight, it is impossible to fulfill the perfect will of God for your life.

When Romans 8 says the Spirit helps our infirmities, it means He is willing to add His muscle to your muscle. No matter how large the mountain is, if it hinders you from fulfilling the will of God in flesh, soul, or doctrine, He supplies the strength you do not have.

He moves the boulder out of your path so you can proceed into the perfect will of God. That is what intercession means here. We are not talking about one moment of a manifestation in a corner. We are talking about the Holy Spirit's whole ministry in you.

As your gift and calling become perfected, God can place them on the pathway of people trying to go to hell. They would get there except for one thing: your anointing and calling stand in the way. That is His job.

It is too bad when people do not have time to pray. It is too bad when the soul has been convinced that other things are more important. That is why Romans 12 calls the body a living sacrifice. It becomes a sacrifice when those free hours belong to God.

Romans 8:22 says:

For we know that the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now.

Creation is like a pregnant woman in travail. What is she pregnant with? A new heaven and a new earth. Creation was subjected to corruption and imperfection through Adam's fall, and it groans to be delivered.

Then Paul distinguishes creation from believers:

And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit...

Creation groans under imperfection, and we groan too, because we have received a new nature but still live in a body that has not yet been redeemed. Our body still shares in this creation's imperfection. We live in an imperfect body in an imperfect world, and the new nature within us experiences both.

That produces a groaning in our spirit. Not necessarily an outward noise, but a deep cry: "I want this to stop. I want suffering to cease. I hate the flesh. I hate the garment spotted by it. I hate my own weaknesses."

If you can watch cultures starve, children suffer, and people die without being moved, then you are not very sensitive to that new nature. A person can be so buried under flesh that he is not even moved by what grieves God.

Romans says we groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption, "to wit, the redemption of our body." "To wit" means to be brought to completion or culmination.

The adoption process will be completed when our bodies are redeemed. The trumpet will sound, and we will go from unglorified to glorified. We will receive a body beyond the temptation of sin, free from the war between the flesh and the new nature.

I look for that day. I look for the manifestation of the sons of God, when Jesus comes, puts down all rule, and creation enters the ages to come free from everything that offends.

Meanwhile, I count it a great privilege to be left in the middle of this war as a minister of reconciliation. My reward is based on taking what heaven has given me and walking the path He gave me. I count it a privilege to receive the Holy Spirit's assistance, let Him help my weaknesses,

and let Him move the mountains out of the way of the perfect will of God.

Romans 8 says:

For we are saved by hope: but hope that is seen is not hope.

We are saved in the hope of total restoration: the redemption of the body, the new heaven, and the new earth. If we already saw it, we would not hope for it. But because we hope for what we do not yet see, we wait for it with patience.

God gave us the Holy Spirit and His power to wait with. That is why the next verse says:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities...

We are in this body, in this world, in this conflict. But God sent the Holy Spirit. He helps our weaknesses, because we do not know how to pray as we ought.

The Spirit searches our hearts and knows the whole plan of God. He knows what mountain or boulder is in the way of your life, whether it is in the flesh, the soul, or wrong doctrine. Because He knows the mind and plan of God, He can make intercession according to the will of God.

Then all things begin to work together for good in those very areas.

The will of God is His plan for your personal life. The purpose of God is the overall plan that spans the ages.

Creation groans toward a new heaven and a new earth. Your calling is your place in that purpose for your generation. When the Holy Spirit gets involved with your life through intercession and supernatural prayer, all things begin to work together for good within that larger purpose.

Romans 8 mentions the whole Godhead. The Holy Spirit helps our infirmities and makes intercession. God the Father is the One whose plan is known. Then Jesus is revealed as the Son to whose image we are being conformed:

For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of his Son...

Those He foreknew, He predestinated before the cross. Those He called, He justified at the cross, and He will glorify at the resurrection. God's purpose spans the ages, but His will for you is worked out in your generation. The Holy Spirit knows that will and has been assigned to help you fulfill it.

What happens when you spend the night in prayer? First, edification begins. Then the Holy Spirit starts the mortification process.

He begins with filthiness of flesh. Your conscience starts waking up. You cannot stay in prayer for hours and keep sinning. You have to stop one or the other. If you keep one foot in the world, living in sin and still going to church, and your conscience is not pricking you, do not imagine that is mercy. It means you are in danger.

When the pressure comes on your conscience, some people run to a place where someone will pat them on the back and tell them they are fine. But the first mortification is the conscience waking up against sin on the flesh level.

Then He moves to the soul: hatred, unforgiveness, strife, and emotional uncleanness. This is when people begin getting indignant about everything around them. The color of the carpet is wrong. The wording is wrong. The mannerisms are wrong. But often the problem is not everyone else. The stronghold in the soul is surfacing.

When God starts dealing with your strife, you may first justify yourself. You go back to prayer, and it bothers you more. Eventually you must either fall out of prayer or stop it.

The path is wider in the flesh than in the Spirit. But you should love God enough to want to please Him.

The last area is spirit, where the Holy Spirit begins purging wrong doctrine. Through the mysteries you pray and the revelation He brings, He begins to teach and correct you.

One man drove trucks for long hours, and that gave him much time to pray in the Holy Ghost. He would write what the Holy Spirit was showing him, and it was striking how much ran parallel with what we were teaching here. That is the check-and-balance system of the same Teacher working in all of us.

What bigger boulder can be moved than wrong believing? What bigger obstruction than strife that lets the devil lasso your ministry? What bigger hindrance than lusts of the flesh so out of control that you cannot quit sinning?

The Holy Spirit wakes up the God-consciousness and the groaning of the new nature. He begins with edification, then deals with flesh, then soul, then doctrine, until the groaning and power begin to come and the office begins to be fulfilled.

If the boulder keeping creative miracles from your life is moved, then suddenly your ministry may look entirely different. Your life and gift may be placed in the path of thousands who were trying to go to hell but cannot get past the anointing God put in your way. That is powerful intercession.

Many people think they are in intercession when they have one foot in the world and add emotional force to prayer. But you cannot motivate God faster than He is moving. If He is creating edification in your spirit, let that flow. When the rest comes, it will come.

Likewise, the Spirit helps our infirmities. He steps in with groanings that cannot be uttered because He knows God's will for your life and where your life fits in God's purpose.

When your heart fully embraces the need and groans out of your righteous spirit, the Spirit says, "I am here. I am adding My muscle to your muscle, and we are going to move this mountain." When the mountain moves, you receive another measure of anointing because you are further along in the plan of God.

After one seeking time, I came out feeling abandoned and lost in my spirit. I did not groan out loud, but inside I felt forsaken, and I cried for almost two days. Then Brother Dene ministered to me through his presence, his words, and the questions I was able to ask. I came through it. Something moved. It may have been a boulder in the way of another boulder, but something moved that I did not have the muscle to move.

That is Romans 8:26. It is not an outbreak in the flesh. It is the Holy Spirit moving what keeps you from the plan and purpose of God.

When the Holy Spirit begins teaching you the mind of the Spirit and the mind of God, the mind of Christ begins its journey to your understanding. Illumination starts.

The mysteries you have been praying in tongues begin to come forward. The same thoughts Paul received when Jesus revealed these mysteries to him begin to be explained to you by the Spirit. That is what makes a teacher out of you.

If Romans 8:22-30 is Paul's flow by the Spirit, then you should find the same flow in other letters. Let us look at 2 Corinthians 5, because it is very close.

Second Corinthians 5 says:

For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

When Jesus rose from the dead in His glorified body, He deposited a glorified body to your account. It is yours, waiting. It is made without hands, eternal in the heavens. It has a spiritual base and can move between realms. It will be flesh, but glorified flesh.

Paul continues:

For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven...

This is the same as Romans 8. We who have the firstfruits of the Spirit groan, waiting for mortality to be swallowed up by life, waiting for the adoption process to be completed at the redemption of our bodies.

We do not groan merely to be unclothed, as though leaving this body behind were the whole goal. We groan to be clothed upon with the house from heaven, so mortality is swallowed up by life.

Second Corinthians 5:5 says:

Now he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.

That is the same thought as Romans 8. We are saved in hope of the day mortality is swallowed up by immortality. God has wrought us for this purpose, and He has also given us the earnest of the Spirit.

Romans says, "Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities." Second Corinthians says God has also given us the earnest of the Spirit. The earnest of the Spirit is the Spirit's intercession and help toward the purpose and plan of God in your life.

He is willing to step in whenever you are ready for the boulders to be moved out of the way. He adds Himself to your life and begins moving what keeps you from the perfect plan and calling of God.

The end of 2 Corinthians 5 speaks of us as new creations and ministers of reconciliation, standing in Christ's stead and reconciling the world to the event of the cross. Romans 8 finishes by asking who can separate us from the love of God. They are saying the same thing from different angles.

If I were you, I would let Him in. I would let the earnest of the Spirit add Himself to my life and begin moving the boulders that keep me from the perfect plan and calling of God.

Where human ability leaves off, His muscle begins. You cannot move that child out of the wheelchair by yourself. But when your heart has enough compassion, the Spirit can add His supernatural groanings to your human groaning and move the mountain that keeps you from the gift needed in your calling.

If you do not have time to pray, you will stay where you are, except for whatever organizational or social skills you already have. You may be able to get five thousand people to do your bidding, but you cannot give them more of God until you have more of Him.

I am looking for the day when God sets people free in every area and we get to teach them how to stay that way. I am looking for the day when semi trucks haul wheelchairs to Goodwill and we sell them to feed the poor.